

Charge your phone and manage battery life

Windows Phones use lithium-ion batteries. Although you probably don't have to plug it in to an outlet right away, the first time you do plug it in, you should allow it to charge overnight. You'll hear all kinds of battery lore out there that's left over from earlier battery technologies. For example, lithium-ion batteries don't have a memory like NiCad batteries did. So, you don't have to be careful to allow the battery to fully discharge before recharging it. Your phone comes with at least one battery charger. When it comes to charging, Windows Phone 7 devices can be very different from one manufacturer to the next. In addition to the battery charger that comes in the box with the phone, you may have several other charging options:

- Wall charger
- Travel charger
- Car charger
- Fuel cell or photocell charger

If you take good care of it, your battery should last about two years with a drop in performance of about 25 percent from the condition it was in when you took it out of the box. At that point, you can replace the battery or upgrade to the newest Windows Phone.

Navigate around the phone

Windows Phone 7 devices differ from other smartphones in that Windows Phones have significantly fewer hardware buttons. In their place is a much heavier reliance on buttons on the screen. In this section, we guide you through your phone's buttons, touch screen, and keyboard.

The phone's buttons

Microsoft has reduced the number of hardware buttons on the Windows Phone 7 device to six, unless the phone has a keyboard. We will cover them all in the following sections.

- ▶ **Buttons on the front:** Beneath the Start screen are three buttons that you use to control what appears on the screen. From left to right, they are the Back button, the Start button, and the Search button
- ▶ **Back:** The Back button on your phone is similar to the Back button in your Web browser on your computer. As you start navigating through the screens on your phone, pressing the Back button takes you back